vanished but whose religious character was in line with Ashoka's. What kind of religious devotion this Dharmarajika evoked among the people of Taxila, who lived within walking distance of it, we cannot know for sure. My own view is that the various goddesses of the Taxilans, and the old rituals around them, were likely to have had more religious power and meaning for the citizens than the grand stupa made at the instance of their emperor.

The emperor's connection with Taxila ends at this point—his stupa there points us in the direction of Buddhism, and towards the time when he had gone beyond being a prince pushed to a frontier.